

- Amendment of Building by laws, master plans for Earthquake Proofing/Flood Management etc.
- Amendment of Building and Land use regulations.
- Flood Plane zoning laws.

Right now a wide variety of activities are in progress to build a solid foundation of disaster preparedness, prevention and mitigation with a view to place India firmly on the path to disaster resilience.

MITIGATION PROJECTS

Following Mitigation projects are being taken up by the NDMA on priority at National level to ensure better preparedness and disaster resilience.

▶ National Cyclone Risk Mitigation Project (NCRMP) covers 13 Cyclone prone coastal states and UTs which aims at strengthening the structural and non structural cyclone mitigation efforts such as improvement of early warning dissemination system, construction of cyclone shelters, roads, bridges, shelter belt plantation etc.

▶ National Earthquake Risk Mitigation Project (NERMP) covers 22 high seismic risk states and UTs which aims at creating enhanced earthquake preparedness through training of engineers, architects, masons etc., strengthening of technological regime, structural safety audit of critical lifeline infrastructure, retrofitting etc.

▶ National Disaster Information and Communication Network (NDICN) aims at providing fail safe communication channels with multiple redundancy and last mile connectivity to disaster-prone communities/districts.

▶ National School Safety Pilot Project aims at strengthening earthquake preparedness of schools in high seismic risk districts through structural safety audit, retrofitting, imparting training and capacity building of critical stakeholders.

▶ National Disaster Response Reserves are being created to meet the emergency relief needs of 4,00,000 persons including 1,50,000 in the hilly regions, in the wake of disaster.

▶ National Landslide Risk Mitigation Project has been drawn up to strengthen landslide risk mitigation measures.

▶ National Flood Risk Mitigation Project aims at strengthening flood preparedness, mitigation and management in the country.

■ Central Ministries/ Departments and States are not only taking up measures for prevention/mitigation/preparedness of disaster but also integrating measures for prevention into its development plans and projects. Hence, this will imply that new investment plans for projects/programmes mandatorily need to have the component of DM measures factored in. Financial Support needs to be arranged for programmes and projects that will lead to sustainable development, with assurance of DM built into them. Even the best of isolated efforts will not bear fruit unless they are part of an overall well considered approach, and roles and

responsibilities of stakeholders are clearly spelt out and accountability and sustainability factored in.

■ The XIth Plan's shift from a response-centric approach to focus on mitigation and prevention brings with it an obligation to give impetus to projects and programmes that develop and nurture, both the culture of disaster safety and integration of disaster prevention and mitigation into development processes.

Based on NDMA's suggestion the Planning Commission has agreed with the proposal that the "generic structure of the DPR" should include coverage of issues relating to disaster resilience. The Finance Ministry, Govt of India has also agreed that the format of the Standing Finance Committee (SFC) / Expenditure Finance Committee (EFC) / Public Investment Board (PIB) memorandum should include consideration of relevant questions relating to whether DM aspects have been built in or not

Planning Commission in the XI Five Year Plan (2007-12) document has laid special emphasis on Disaster Management by:

- Outlining actions that need to be taken by the various Central Ministries/ Departments and State Governments.
- Giving guidelines for taking up projects and programmes in DM.
- Suggesting programmes/schemes that need to be taken up in the 11th Five Year Plan.
- Bringing out importance of earmarking plan funds for projects and add value to the National DM effort.

■ The XIth Plan aims at consolidating the process by giving impetus to projects and programmes that develop and nurture the culture of safety and the integration of disaster prevention and mitigation into the developmental process.

■ As a part of the effort of mainstreaming DM concerns into the overall developmental effort, the Planning Commission has now agreed to the conduct of a DM audit of all new and on-going projects and selective revisiting of completed projects. It has accepted the need to ensure funding for this activity, as well as support the measures arising from the DM Plans required to be made by the Central Ministries/Departments and the States/Union Territories.



Dr. Mohan Kanda

Member,

NATIONAL DISASTER MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY

